

SkillVerse Research

Screen2Skill 2026

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Coding as a Gateway Skill

How 43% of Students Learned to Code Online

Coding Demographics

43% of students in our survey can code, with 67% learning through online resources. Top starting ages: 14-16. Top motivations: career (52%), curiosity (45%), creativity (32%), income (28%).

Learning Resources

freeCodeCamp (28%), YouTube tutorials (61%), The Odin Project (12%), Codecademy (15%), CS50 (19%), Scrimba (8%), Personal projects (71%).

First Projects

Most common first projects: calculator (18%), to-do list (24%), personal website (32%), game (15%), Discord bot (8%), weather app (12%).

Career Impact

Of those who code, 34% have freelanced. 18% have internships. 8% have full-time offers before age 18. Average first freelance project: ₹15,000 INR.